

Manzil — Server Hosting Cost Comparison

Prepared for client review | Region: Europe | Date: 01 July 2026

Sizing basis: up to 15 concurrent users, 5,000–10,000 database records per year (Node.js/Express API + PostgreSQL + React frontend). This is a light workload — the smallest production-grade tier from each provider is sufficient with comfortable headroom for growth.

Compute (Server) Comparison

Provider	Plan	vCPU	RAM	SSD	Est. Cost/mo
Hetzner	CX22	2	4 GB	40 GB	~\$5
DigitalOcean	Basic Droplet	1	2 GB	50 GB	~\$12
Contabo	VPS S	4	8 GB	150 GB	~\$7
AWS EC2	t4g.small (ARM) + 20GB EBS	2	2 GB	20 GB	~\$14

Notes: Hetzner offers the best price-to-performance ratio for this workload. AWS EC2 pricing above excludes data transfer and snapshot backup costs (adds roughly \$2–3/mo). All plans include enough headroom to handle 5–10x the current expected load without resizing.

File / Document Storage — Amazon S3

For storing uploaded documents, PDFs, and case files, Amazon S3 is recommended as the sole storage solution regardless of which provider hosts the application server. S3 is used purely for object storage (files), decoupled from the compute layer, and offers industry-standard durability, security, and lifecycle management.

Component	Estimated Usage	Est. Cost/mo
Storage (S3 Standard)	~5 GB documents	~\$0.12
PUT/COPY/POST requests	~2,000 requests/mo	~\$0.01
GET requests	~5,000 requests/mo	~\$0.002
Data transfer out	~1 GB/mo	~\$0.09

Total estimated S3 cost at this scale: well under \$1/mo. Cost scales automatically with actual usage — no wasted capacity, no manual resizing.

**Recommended Package
& Total Monthly Cost**

Server (Hetzner CX22)	~\$5.00
Object Storage (AWS S3)	~\$0.25
Domain + SSL (Let's Encrypt)	Free (domain billed separately/yearly)
Automated backups (off-site)	~\$1.00

Total estimated: ~\$6–7/month

Included Security Measures

- SSH key-only authentication (no password login)
- UFW firewall — only ports 22 (SSH), 80 (HTTP), 443 (HTTPS) open
- Nginx reverse proxy with free Let's Encrypt SSL/TLS certificate
- Database bound to localhost only — never publicly exposed
- fail2ban — automatic blocking of brute-force login attempts
- Automatic OS security updates (unattended-upgrades)
- Nightly encrypted database backups stored off-server
- Non-root deployment user with least-privilege access